

Student Support Future-State Decision Workshop

90 minutes | Purpose: validate the problem, align on design principles and agree what to test before a larger transformation decision.

Decision required from the room
What should we test in a 12-week pilot before committing to a larger technology or operating-model change?

- Which pain points are material and in scope?
- What future-state principles are non-negotiable?
- What is the smallest useful pilot?
- How will we know whether to scale, iterate or stop?

Participants

- Executive sponsor
- Student/service leaders
- Faculty / local representatives
- Frontline SMEs
- Digital / IT
- Data / analytics
- Risk / privacy
- Student representative

Pre-work

- 2-page pre-read
- Available demand + flow data
- Known policy / control constraints
- One evidence-based pain point per participant
- Sponsor pre-wire on decision and guardrails

Time	Activity	Facilitator move	Output
0-10	Frame the decision	Confirm purpose, scope, guardrails and what is not being decided today.	Shared decision statement
10-25	Evidence check	Label facts, assumptions and hypotheses. Surface where the data is weak.	Agreed evidence gaps
25-45	Map friction	Trace handoffs, repeat work, ownership gaps and exceptions across the journey.	Priority pain points
45-60	Root causes + design principles	Ask what must be true in a better future state before discussing systems.	3-5 design principles
60-75	Stress-test options	Compare standardisation, common triage and platform change against impact, effort and risk.	Preferred direction + trade-offs
75-85	Define pilot	Agree pilot scope, measures, participants, controls and exclusions.	Minimum useful pilot
85-90	Commit	Read back decisions, owners, open questions and next review date.	Decision log + owners

Prompts I would use

- What evidence would change our mind?
- Which handoff is necessary, and which is historical?
- Are we solving a symptom or a root cause?
- What can we learn in 12 weeks?

When views conflict
Do not vote too early.

If one group wants more people, another wants automation and another wants local autonomy, reframe the disagreement into testable hypotheses about demand, process, ownership and technology.

Workshop outputs

- Decision log
- Pilot scope
- Success measures
- Named owners
- Open questions
- Dependencies / risks

After the room

- Issue notes within 24 hours
- Confirm owners and due dates
- Update future-state / process view
- Translate unresolved items into analysis or delivery backlog